

Betty was given to me a few years ago by my uncle, who told me she was the hardest-working dog he'd ever had. No one knew exactly how old she was, because she'd been passed around among different farmers for years . . . and now she was at my farm.

Suddenly I had two dogs: Betty the wonder working dog, and Buffett, my very cute (and very blond) golden retriever that I've had for nine years now. His skills include sleeping, eating, and laying giant turds in the middle of the lawn.

Buffett eats his expensive dietary dog food from his doggie bowl.

Yet when I bought Betty her own bowl, she cocked her head and wouldn't eat.

'Maybe she's feeling insecure about her new environment, and she's off her food,' proffered my animal-loving wife.

My uncle had other ideas: 'Just tip the food on the ground.'

Betty dutifully started chowing down.

Buffett sleeps in a kennel with a sheepskin for warmth.

Betty sleeps on the dirt underneath the ute . . . so she doesn't miss one minute of work.

Buffett thinks sheep are his friends (they do look roughly the same) and plays with them till he gets bored, which doesn't take long.

Betty, on the other paw, almost jumps out of her skin when it's time to work. She listens intently to my commands, studying my face like a poker player, and then darts off into the distance to round up the sheep.

Once, she went missing when we were out working. After spending over an hour searching for her, I gave up—and drove home. 'That's the last we'll see of Betty,' I announced, stretching for a beer.

And an hour later, Betty returned panting and exhausted . . . with three dazed sheep in tow.

'Betty found three sheep!' said my wife.